

FreshRoute SA

Agriculture Coordination System - Non-Technical System Overview

Document purpose

This document explains how FreshRoute SA will work in simple business language. It is written for founders, partners, investors, coordinators, farmer leaders, and buyer representatives who do not need technical system details.

Business type	Fresh-produce coordination, aggregation, delivery, and payment management
First market	South Africa, starting with Gauteng buyers and nearby producer groups
Main buyers	Restaurants, fresh produce shops, food box businesses, resellers, canteens, and independent retailers
Main income	Commission, delivery fees, price margin, buyer subscriptions, and quality premiums

Version 1.0

1. Executive summary

FreshRoute SA is a coordination business that connects small farmers and farmer groups with buyers who need reliable fresh produce. The system helps farmers sell more consistently, helps buyers receive better supply, and allows FreshRoute to earn as the organized middleman.

The business should begin with a controlled pilot, not a nationwide public marketplace. The first version should focus on a small number of crops, a small number of reliable farmers, and repeat buyers in Gauteng.

Simple explanation

FreshRoute SA works like a professional bridge between scattered farmers and serious buyers. It organizes supply, checks quality, arranges delivery, collects payment, and pays farmers after successful delivery.

What FreshRoute does	Why it matters
Collects crop information from farmers	FreshRoute knows what can be sold before the harvest is wasted.
Finds buyers and collects demand	The business sells based on real market demand.
Matches supply to orders	One buyer order can be fulfilled by several small farmers.
Checks quality before delivery	Buyers trust the supply and disputes are reduced.
Controls payment and farmer settlement	FreshRoute protects its commission and reduces bypassing.

2. The problem being solved

Many small farmers and producer groups have fresh crops but struggle to reach stable, better-paying markets. At the same time, restaurants, shops, food box businesses, and traders need fresh produce regularly but do not want the stress of coordinating many small suppliers.

Group	Main problem
Farmers	They may produce good crops but lack reliable buyers, market information, transport, and negotiation power.
Buyers	They need consistent quantity, quality, delivery, and pricing.
FreshRoute	FreshRoute can create value by organizing the process and earning from successful coordination.

Important reality

The app is not the whole business. The real business is organized supply, buyer trust, quality control, delivery, and payment management. The software simply makes those operations easier to run.

3. How the system works in simple terms

FreshRoute SA operates through a controlled chain. Every crop listing, buyer request, order, delivery, and payment is tracked so the business can manage quality, profit, and accountability.

1. Farmers declare available crops	Farmer or Area Coordinator	FreshRoute knows what is available, where it is, and when it can be harvested.
2. Buyers submit demand	Buyer or FreshRoute Admin	FreshRoute knows what buyers need and when they need it.
3. FreshRoute matches supply and demand	Admin	A buyer order is matched with one or more farmers.
4. Quality is checked	Coordinator or Inspector	Only acceptable produce is prepared for delivery.
5. Delivery is arranged	Driver and Admin	Produce moves from collection point to buyer.
6. Buyer accepts delivery	Buyer	Delivery proof is captured and disputes are reduced.
7. Payment is settled	Finance/Admin	FreshRoute deducts its income and pays farmers.

4. Main people involved

Role	Plain-language responsibility
Admin	Runs the business dashboard, approves information, creates orders, manages payments, and checks reports.
Area Coordinator	Works with farmers in one area, records harvest information, uploads photos, and helps organize collection.
Farmer	Produces crops and receives payment after successful sale.
Buyer	Requests fresh produce, receives deliveries, pays invoices, and rates quality.
Driver	Collects and delivers produce while capturing pickup and delivery proof.
Quality Inspector	Checks produce quality, records accepted quantity, and rejects poor produce when necessary.
Finance User	Tracks buyer payments, unpaid invoices, farmer payouts, and FreshRoute earnings.

Protection rule

Farmers should not see buyer phone numbers, and buyers should not see farmer phone numbers. FreshRoute must remain the trusted coordination point between both sides.

5. Weekly operating routine

The first version should run on a simple weekly rhythm. This keeps the business organized and helps control delivery costs.

Day	What happens	Main output
Monday	Area Coordinators update farmer supply, expected harvest dates, photos, and prices.	Verified supply list for the week.
Tuesday	Buyers submit demand or FreshRoute contacts recurring buyers.	Buyer requests are collected.
Wednesday	FreshRoute matches demand with available supply and prepares quotes.	Match suggestions and buyer quotations.
Thursday	Buyers confirm orders and farmers confirm final quantities.	Confirmed orders and reserved stock.
Friday/Saturday	Collection, quality check, delivery, and buyer acceptance happen.	Delivered orders and payment records.
After delivery	FreshRoute confirms payment, deducts fees, and pays farmers.	Closed order and farmer settlement.

6. Example order journey

This example shows how one buyer order can be supplied by several small farmers.

Step	Example
Buyer request	A restaurant needs 100 kg of tomatoes and 30 bunches of spinach by Friday morning.
Supply found	Farmer A has 40 kg tomatoes, Farmer B has 35 kg tomatoes, Farmer C has 25 kg tomatoes, and Farmer D has spinach.
Order created	FreshRoute combines the farmers into one buyer order.
Quality check	Accepted produce is graded and poor produce is rejected before delivery.
Delivery	The driver delivers everything as one FreshRoute order.
Payment	Buyer pays FreshRoute. FreshRoute deducts commission and delivery costs, then pays farmers.

7. What the system must control

The system should protect FreshRoute from common problems in fresh-produce trading: bad quality, late supply, buyer cancellation, unpaid invoices, and people bypassing the platform.

Control area	What the system should do
Quality control	Record photos, grade produce, track accepted and rejected quantities, and keep rejection reasons.
Stock control	When produce is matched to an order, it must be reserved so it is not sold twice.
Payment control	Buyer payments should go through FreshRoute before farmer settlements are released.
Contact control	Protect farmer and buyer contact details to reduce bypassing.
Delivery control	Capture pickup proof, delivery proof, delivery status, and any problems.
Performance control	Track reliable farmers, repeat buyers, rejected produce, late deliveries, and unpaid balances.

8. Quality grades

FreshRoute should use simple quality grades that everyone understands.

Grade	Meaning	Best buyer type
Grade A	Very fresh, clean, and consistent size.	Restaurants, premium shops, food box businesses.
Grade B	Good quality but mixed size or appearance.	General shops, traders, local markets.
Grade C	Lower quality but still usable.	Processing, discount buyers, bulk traders.
Rejected	Not acceptable for sale.	Not delivered to buyer.

Do not overpromise organic

At the beginning, use terms like fresh, locally grown, naturally produced, or community verified. Only use certified organic or PGS verified when there is real proof and a clear verification process.

9. Main system areas

The platform should be divided into simple business areas. These are not technical modules for the reader; they are the main work areas of the business.

System area	What it helps the business do
Dashboard	Shows the health of the business at a glance: farmers, buyers, orders, revenue, deliveries, and unpaid money.
Farmers	Stores farmer details, locations, crops, farmer groups, and reliability history.
Buyers	Stores buyer details, delivery addresses, payment terms, and order history.
Crop availability	Shows what crops are available, expected harvest dates, prices, photos, and quantities.
Buyer requests	Records what buyers want, when they want it, and their preferred quality.
Matching	Helps FreshRoute connect buyer demand with farmer supply.
Orders	Tracks confirmed buyer orders from creation to completion.
Quality checks	Records inspection results, grades, photos, and rejected produce.
Deliveries	Tracks pickup, driver assignment, delivery status, and proof of delivery.
Payments	Tracks buyer payments, FreshRoute commission, delivery fees, and farmer payouts.
Reports	Shows sales, profit, crop performance, buyer performance, farmer performance, and risk.

10. What each user should see

User	What they should see
Admin	Everything needed to run operations, approve actions, track orders, manage money, and view reports.
Coordinator	Only farmers, crop availability, collection schedules, quality issues, and payouts for their assigned area.
Farmer	Their own crops, accepted quantities, rejected quantities, and payment status.
Buyer	Their requests, orders, delivery status, invoices, and quality ratings.
Driver	Only assigned pickups and deliveries.
Finance	Payments, invoices, outstanding balances, farmer settlements, and revenue reports.

11. Money flow

FreshRoute should control the money flow. This is how the business protects its income and keeps records clear.

Buyer invoice is created	Admin/Finance	Buyer knows the produce cost, delivery fee, and total amount.
Buyer pays FreshRoute	Buyer	Payment is recorded against the order.
FreshRoute deducts income	Finance	Commission, delivery fee, and agreed costs are deducted.
Farmer payout is calculated	System/Finance	Each farmer receives payment based on accepted quantity.
Farmer is paid	Finance	Settlement is marked as paid.

Income type	How FreshRoute earns
Commission	A percentage of the order value.
Delivery fee	A delivery charge paid by the buyer.
Price margin	FreshRoute buys at one price and sells at a higher price when demand is confirmed.
Buyer subscription	Recurring buyers pay monthly for priority sourcing and coordination.
Quality premium	Traceable and better-graded produce can be sold at a higher value.

Cashflow rule

New buyers should pay before delivery or on delivery. Credit terms should only be given after a buyer has a reliable payment history.

12. Recommended first version

The first version should be small and controlled. The aim is to prove repeat orders, reliable supply, quality control, and profit before expanding.

Pilot decision	Recommended choice
First region	Gauteng buyers, supplied by nearby peri-urban farmers and selected producer groups.
Farmers	Start with about 50 farmers or a few reliable groups.
Buyers	Start with 10 to 15 restaurants, shops, resellers, or food box businesses.
Crops	Start with tomatoes, onions, spinach, cabbage, and carrots.
Delivery rhythm	Two fixed delivery days per week at first.
Technology	Admin dashboard first, coordinator portal second, buyer portal third.

13. Step-by-step launch plan

Phase	What to build or do	Goal
Phase 1	Run operations with an internal admin dashboard and manual coordination.	Control the business and learn the real workflow.
Phase 2	Give coordinators a simple mobile-friendly portal to submit supply.	Improve farmer data collection.
Phase 3	Give buyers a simple portal to request and repeat orders.	Make demand collection easier.
Phase 4	Add driver and quality-check workflows with photo proof.	Reduce disputes and protect the business.
Phase 5	Add automation such as matching suggestions, route planning, and reports.	Scale the business more efficiently.

Best launch strategy

Do not launch publicly on day one. Run a controlled pilot, manually support users, and improve the system based on real orders.

14. Main risks and how to reduce them

Risk	How FreshRoute should reduce it
Farmers promise more than they can supply	Use coordinators to verify quantities before orders are confirmed.
Buyers reject produce	Use quality grading and photos before delivery.
Buyers pay late	Limit credit and require upfront or delivery payment for new buyers.
Produce gets damaged in transport	Use proper packaging, photo records, and clear responsibility rules.
Farmers and buyers bypass FreshRoute	Protect contact information and provide value through logistics, payment handling, quality control, and recurring orders.
Delivery costs become too high	Use fixed delivery days and route batching.
Too many crops make operations messy	Start with five crops only, then expand after repeat demand is proven.

15. Success measures

Metric	Why it matters
Number of repeat buyers	Shows whether buyers trust FreshRoute.
Weekly order value	Shows the size of the business being handled.
Commission revenue	Shows FreshRoute core income.
Delivery profit	Shows whether logistics are sustainable.
Rejected produce rate	Shows quality control performance.
On-time delivery rate	Shows buyer service reliability.
Farmer fulfillment rate	Shows whether farmers are reliable.
Unpaid buyer balance	Shows cashflow risk.

16. First 90-day target

Target area	Suggested target
Registered farmers	50 farmers or a few strong producer groups.
Active buyers	10 to 15 buyers.
Recurring weekly buyers	At least 10.
Crops handled	5 crops only.

Target area	Suggested target
Weekly order value	R30,000 to R50,000 after the pilot stabilizes.
Commission	10 percent to 15 percent per completed order.
Main proof of success	Buyers reorder and farmers are paid consistently.

17. What FreshRoute should not do at the beginning

- Do not start with a nationwide launch.
- Do not begin by targeting big supermarket chains.
- Do not buy large stock without confirmed buyer demand.
- Do not claim certified organic without proof.
- Do not build too many advanced features before real orders exist.
- Do not allow direct buyer-farmer contact inside the platform.
- Do not offer long credit terms to new buyers.

18. Plain-language glossary

Term	Meaning
Supply	The crops farmers have available or expect to harvest.
Demand	What buyers want to purchase.
Matching	Connecting buyer demand with farmer supply.
Aggregation	Combining produce from multiple farmers into one larger order.
Quality grading	Classifying produce as Grade A, Grade B, Grade C, or rejected.
Settlement	The final payment made to a farmer after a successful sale.
Commission	FreshRoute percentage earned from a successful order.
GMV	Total value of all produce sold through FreshRoute.

Final summary

FreshRoute SA should start as a focused, controlled coordination business. The system should help the team know what farmers can supply, what buyers need, which orders are profitable, which produce passed quality checks, which deliveries are complete, and which payments are still pending. Build the business workflow first, then build technology around that workflow.